DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 8

CRM administrator

Profession 8 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A CRM administrator sets up and maintains the customer relationship management system: the fields, pipeline stages, users, automations and data quality. The system is only as good as its records.

What professionals do every day

Configures pipeline stages, cleans duplicate contacts, sets user roles, builds reports and trains the team on data entry rules.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Sales and support teams depend on one trusted list of customers. An administrator keeps that list accurate and useful.

- Duplicate contacts that split history.
- Pipeline stages nobody uses correctly.
- Users with more access than they need.

Skills you need

- CRM configuration.
- Data quality.
- Reports.
- User roles and security.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
HubSpot CRM	CRM with free tools	Free tier	Paid plans	www.hubspot.com
Zoho CRM	CRM for small teams	Free plan (check current)	Paid plans	www.zoho.com/crm/
Salesforce	Enterprise CRM	Trial (check current)	Subscription	www.salesforce.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Set up five pipeline stages with clear entry rules.
Intermediate	Find and merge duplicate contacts.
Advanced	Create a role matrix for three user groups.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** CRM set-up for a small agency.

- **Intermediate:** Clean-up of a customer list before a campaign.
- **Advanced:** Monthly pipeline report.

Client-ready portfolio project

A CRM set-up pack for a fictional agency: five stages, a duplicate-check method, a role matrix and one pipeline report.

Worked example

Worked example. Two contacts share the email 'Asha@Example.com' and 'asha@example.com'. Normalising emails to lower case shows they are one person, so the records are merged and the history is kept.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Find duplicate contacts

Business problem: A CRM holds contacts with inconsistent emails and spaces in phone numbers.

Steps

1. Normalise each email to lower case and trim spaces.
2. Group the records by the cleaned email.
3. Review each group before merging; keep the most complete record.
4. Count the duplicates merged.

Expected output: The duplicate groups and the count merged.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

PYTHON

```
def norm_email(e):
    return e.strip().lower()

def duplicate_groups(contacts):
    groups = {}
    for c in contacts:
        groups.setdefault(norm_email(c['email']), []).append(c['id'])
    return {k: v for k, v in groups.items() if len(v) > 1}

contacts = [
    {'id':'C1','email':'Asha@Example.com'},
    {'id':'C2','email':' asha@example.com '},
    {'id':'C3','email':'ravi@example.com'},
]
print(duplicate_groups(contacts))
assert duplicate_groups(contacts) == {'asha@example.com': ['C1','C2']}
print('duplicate test passed')
```

The test confirms the two Asha records are grouped together. Review each group before merging, because two people may share an inbox.

Common mistakes

- Changing stage names without telling the team.
- Giving everyone administrator rights.
- Deleting records instead of archiving them.
- No naming rules for fields.

Freelancing opportunities

- CRM set-up and clean-up for small firms.
- Monthly CRM reports and dashboards.
- Briefs for 'CRM administrator', 'HubSpot', 'Salesforce admin'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- HubSpot Academy (free courses)

Part of **Master Freelancing: Admin and Business Support**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.